The Megaphone

ECCO EQUIPMENT CORPORATION

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ECCO is Critical Flatiron Partner in Golden Gate Bridge Project

By Dennis Kenavey—When it came to replacing the old Doyle Drive 101 north approach to the world's most famous bridge, Superintendent Freddie Cargile of Flatiron Western Division, Benicia District knew he could depend on ECCO Equipment Corporation to help get the job done.

The completion of the new 1.1 billion dollar Presidio Parkway approach to the Golden Gate Bridge will finish up with a beautiful hiking trail and landscaping by 2016. Flatiron was under immense pressure to complete their part of the project on time in order to get the approach open for the busy Monday morning rush hour commute into San Francisco.

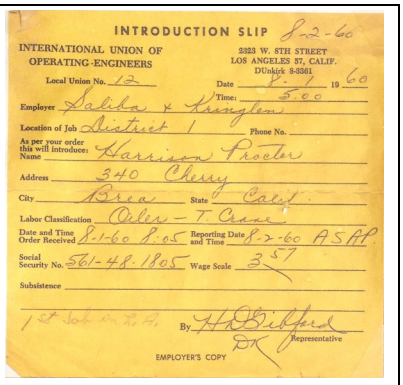
ECCO supplied a Cat D8T with GPS, a Cat D6N LGP, a Cat 365B, a Cat 345D, a Cat 740B and a Volvo A40F for the job. Flatiron had 4 days to complete the final "touchdown" to the bridge and had crews on the jobsite 24 hours a day towards the end of the completion of the project!

ECCO's Stockton field service mechanic Gregg Heim was on call around the clock to support the machines but his services were not needed! The equipment performed flawlessly! Once again ECCO Equipment Corporation teamed up with a great customer, Flatiron, to provide the best equipment from the most reliable rental company in the industry!

Torrey Pines Lagoon Gets Help

In previous decades, Torrey Pines Lagoon was a healthy ecosystem. The combination of higher rainfall together with a larger lagoon area and a less restricted entrance provided sufficient flow to keep a channel open through to the beach. Such a continuous connection with the sea is important for the survival of a normal lagoon flora and fauna. Under present conditions, however, a permanent opening cannot be naturally maintained and the marine life has diminished and at times has been almost eliminated. During exceptionally wet winters, sufficient runoff may accumulate in the lagoon to break through the barrier bar naturally. But if the bar is not breached in this manner, the channel is bulldozed open to alleviate the danger of flooding and to improve the health of the lagoon. The **California Dept of Parks and Recreation** called upon ECCO to provide a Cat D6T LGP dozer and Volvo A40D truck to clear the channel this past season. Sometimes nature needs a helping hand.

The Story of Harrison Proctor


INTRODUCTION SLIP 8-2-60
INTERNATIONAL UNION OF OPERATING ENGINEERS
3223 W. 8TH STREET LOS ANGELES 57, CALIF. DUnkirk 8-3361
Local Union No. 12 Date 8-1 1960 Time: 5:00
Employer Saliba & Kingston
Location of Job District 1 Phone No.
As per your order this will introduce: Name Harrison Proctor
Address 340 Cherry
City Brea State Calif.
Labor Classification Oiler - T Crane
Date and Time Order Received 8-1-60 8:05 Reporting Date and Time 8-2-60 ASAP
Social Security No. 561-48-1805 Wage Scale 3.57
Subsistence
By H. D. Bibford Representative
EMPLOYER'S COPY

Harry Proctor will forever be famous in ECCO lore as the first man to rent a piece of equipment. The year was 1962 and Harry was a crane operator for Ecco Contractors (founded in 1959) since 1960. (See Introduction Slip at right.) Business was a little slow, so Harry took it upon himself to rent an Ecco crane and his services as an operator to another contractor. Shortly thereafter, Ecco needed the crane for a project, but it was now unavailable. Founder Don Schmid saw this as an excellent reason to purchase another crane. Well, the new crane eventually became idle and Harry rented it too, so when Ecco needed it, another purchase was necessary. This pattern repeated itself with many different types of equipment until 1972, when Ecco Contractors was split into two companies: BFI Constructors, and ECCO Equipment Corporation.

Harry became the general manager of the new rental company. He was well known for efficiency. Repair parts were often left by the side of the road by one mechanic so that another mechanic headed toward a downed machine could retrieve them on his way. He retired in 1985 and moved to Bishop, CA, but continued to work for ECCO as an consultant, inspecting equipment for purchase all over the country. His license plate, LKN4IRN, symbolized his ongoing quest to find good heavy equipment.

Harry during a visit with David Schmid in December 2014.

In 2002, he retired for good to McKinleyville, CA (near Eureka) where every day, into his nineties, he would chop wood and ride his bicycle to the beach. As the years went on, communicating with Harry became more and more of a challenge because his years spent around loud machinery had rendered him almost completely deaf. He kept a notepad handy for visitors to write down what they wanted to say and then he would fire back an answer or another question. Tough to keep up. He always wanted to know how ECCO was doing, what equipment we had purchased lately, and how his old friends were doing. He passed away in Jan 2015, at the age of 91, the last of the original Ecco Contractors.

Rob Engert Celebrates 20 Years with ECCO

Service Technician Rob Engert was recently recognized at a luncheon in Las Vegas for 20 years of outstanding service to ECCO Equipment. As the most senior of all Las Vegas employees, Rob remembers the humble beginnings of the branch. In 1996, they were working out of a small office with no covered work area. Now the yard is twice the size, with upgraded service bays and plans for a new wash bay. Rob noted that the newer equipment and service trucks make his job easier than ever.

The Making of a Chicken Farm

The Phoenix branch was proud to partner with Markham Contracting on the **Lone Cactus Farm** in Bouse AZ, located 26 miles SE of Parker. It will be the new home of many chickens that may supply eggs for your breakfast. **Jeff Hightower** was instrumental in securing this project for ECCO which included six 631 scrapers, one D9R, one D8T, two 8K water pulls, one 815F, and two 623's. The job was supported onsite by ECCO mechanics, **Brad McManis** and **Jesse Gerhardt** who worked six 10 hour shifts per week to keep the job running smoothly. **Frank Alvarez** was also key in managing the service due to the location. The equipment preformed excellently and allowed Markham to complete the project on time.

New Equipment Arrives in Time for Spring Season

Dozers
Deere 750K XLT
Cat D6T
Cat D6T LGP
Cat D6T XW
Cat D8T
Cat D8T
Cat D9T
Cat D10T

Excavators
Cat 320E LRR
Cat 321D LCR
Cat 328D LCR
Cat 328D LCR
Cat 329D L
Cat 336E L
Cat 336E L
Cat 349E L

Loaders
Cat 950K
Cat 950K
Cat 980H

Motorgraders
Cat 140M2
Cat 14M
Deere 872G

Scrapers
Cat 623H
Cat 623H
Cat 631G

Off-Hwy Trucks
Cat 740B
Cat 740B
Cat 740B
Cat 740
Cat 740

Water Wagons
Cat 613C II 5K WW
Cat 613C II 5K WW
Cat 613C II 5K WW

Water Towers
Klein KPT-120
Klein KPT-120
Klein KPT-120
Klein KPT-120

Vehicles
Ford F150 XL
Ford F150 XL
Ford F350 Flatbed
Ford F750 Service
Ford F750 Service

Compactors
Cat CS56

ECCO customers demand and deserve reliable, late model equipment. The equipment to the left has been purchased since October 1, 2015, at a cost of over $6 million, demonstrating ECCO's commitment to continuous reinvestment in the company.

ECCO 2012 Cat 623H with Accugrade

Doing a Good Turn

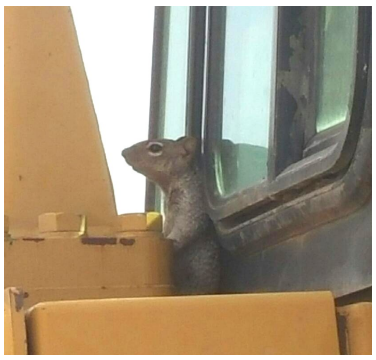
There's a 10 mile dirt road between the pavement and **Lost Valley Scout Camp** in San Diego County. At no cost to the scouts, ECCO operator Ralph Gonzalez spent two days last spring improving that road and the roads in camp in preparation for the summer influx of boy scouts. The camp ranger said the roads have never been better!

Recent Human Additions

Jason Waldron, Jr.

Dave Novak & grandson

Operator Shortage!



Some contractors in Phoenix have been creative in solving an operator shortage. Although not all squirrels have excellent skills, the good news is that they'll work for peanuts!

Dennis Kenavey's twin grandkids

Ken Miles & grandson

Recent Snow as seen from ECCO Branches (Can you identify the branch?)

First Quarter Anniversaries

January • February • March

Mendoza, Veronica	Dispatcher	Visalia	30 years	Franczak, Thomas	Mechanic	Las Vegas	4 years
Johnson, Rick	Mechanic	Santa Ana	24 years	Weed, Ryan	Mechanic	Riverside	4 years
Lloyd, Denny	Field Rep	Santa Ana	23 years	Ricke, Kelsey	Dispatcher	Edmonton	4 years
Kisner, Helene	Controller	Santa Ana	21 years	Alvarez, Frank	Service Mgr	Phoenix	4 years
Rohman, Bryan	Mechanic	Visalia	21 years	McCormac, Sam	Field Rep	Lindon	3 years
Engert, Robert	Mechanic	Las Vegas	20 years	Kuewa, Justin	Dispatcher	Las Vegas	3 years
Novak, Dave	Regional Mgr	Santa Ana	14 years	Vawdrey, Curtis	Mechanic	Lindon	3 years
Prusha, Miles	Mechanic	Santa Ana	12 years	McDade, Paul	Field Rep	Sacramento	2 years
Finke, Rick	Service Mgr	Santa Ana	10 years	Centeno-Cooper, Anna		Office Visalia	2 years
Hagerty, James	Mechanic	Las Vegas	10 years	Ryan, Patrick	Dispatcher	Williston	1 year
Turpin, Grant	Service Mgr	Lindon	10 years	Hulett, Ryan	Mechanic	Caldwell	1 year
Russell, Nelson	Regional Mgr	Williston	6 years	Jimenez, Susana	Staff Accnt	Santa Ana	1 year
Andersen, Brian	Mechanic	Ft. McMurray	5 years	Crumly, Wyatt	Yardman	Visalia	1 year
Gonzalez, Ralph	Operator	Santa Ana	4 years	Madril, Chad	Service Mgr	Las Vegas	1 year

Answers to snow photos (left to right): Phoenix AZ, Williston ND, Lindon UT, Santa Ana CA, Ft McMurray AB, Coachella CA, Visalia CA, Las Vegas NV, Riverside CA